

'Tis so on earth ; they who have entrance found
 Into kings' presence-chambers, are withdrawn
 From sight of them without ; and if there dawn
 Ought of their fame beyond that sacred bound,
 'Tis at their issuing, with high mandates crown'd,
 In order from their sovereign. If their train
 Sow blessing, yet how oft for them in vain !
 Who first found out, and in what cave profound,
 The arts which feed us ? Who taught praise to own
 Melodious wings, and fill'd the breathing gold
 With a sweet soul ? Who were the good of old ?
 Most like good angels, sure, they whose sweet lot
 It is to bless us, though we know it not ;
 Like Him in whom we live, Himself unseen, unknown.

SPECIMENS OF TRANSLATIONS FROM BUNSEN'S GERMAN HYMN AND PRAYER BOOK.

CHRISTMAS HYMN.

PSALM liii. 7, 8.—“Oh that the salvation were given unto Israel out of Sion : Oh that the Lord would deliver his people out of captivity. Then should Jacob rejoice, and Israel should be glad.”

EMMANUEL, we sing thy praise,
 Thou Prince of Life, and Fount of Grace,
 Thou Flow'r of Heaven, Star of Morn,
 Lord of all Lords, the virgin-born.

We 'mid thine host devoutly bring
 Honour and praise, our offering ;
 That thou at length hast come and blest
 Our sight, O long, long-wish'd-for guest !

For thee, since when the world was made,
 How many hearts have watch'd and pray'd ;
 For thee, with what protracted pain,
 Prophets and fathers sigh'd in vain.

Ah ! that from Zion's hill the Lord
 Would come to cast our bonds abroad ;
 Ah ! might we hear the Saviour's voice ;
 Then Israel should indeed rejoice.

Now here thou art ; thou slumberest,
 Taking in lowly crib thy rest ;
 Thou mad'st the world, that art so small ;
 Naked thou art, who clothest all.

Thou com'st a stranger in the land,
 Yet are the heav'ns at thy command ;
 Thou drinkest at a woman's breast,
 Who art 'mid angels God confest.

So without fear I cling to thee ;
 Thou from all sorrow mak'st me free ;
 Thou bindest death, our griefs dost bear,
 And turn'st to joy all pain and care.

Thou art our head ; I, too, will be
 Entirely thine, a limb of thee ;
 So shall I serve thee in true faith,
 As thy good grace may grant, till death.

I'll chant thine hallelujah song
 On earth with joy my whole life long ;
 Then in thy glory-hall again,
 Where time is not, renew the strain.

[This Hymn was written by Paul Gerhard, before 1671.]

NEW YEAR'S HYMN.

"Thou crownest the year with thy goodness, and thy paths drop fatness."—Ps. lxx. 12.

LORD, thou that ever wast, and art !
 The year hath pass'd away,
 And claims from thankful voice and heart
 The tribute of a lay :
 Thanks, Lord, for life, and peace, and rest,
 For counsel, comfort, all the best,
 Each act of every day.

Let this year also blessed be
 Which thou dost newly give ;
 Grant to us power (power flows from thee)
 In fear of thee to live :
 Thou guardest us, O Lord, thou pour'st
 Increase of good on men when first
 They for thy kingdom strive.

Oh, grant me peace and joy this year ;
 But should from fortune spring
 Corruption, let me rather bear
 A cross and suffering ;
 Let me with patience arm my mind,
 Nor cast on him a thought unkind
 To whom thy mercies cling.

Guard, with a father's love, thine own
 This year, O Lord, again ;
 Take pity on the outcast's groan ;
 Help all afflicted men ;
 Let blessings each good act attend ;
 Thy Spirit on our princes send,
 To counsel and restrain,

That Wisdom, Justice, so may thrive,
 And share with them their seat ;
 That Virtue and Content may live
 Here in a safe retreat ;
 That with us Faith and Love may be ;
 Grant this, O Father, this which we
 Through Christ thy Son intreat.

[By Christian Fürchtegott Gellert. 1757.]